

» THE YEAR THAT WAS VANTAGE POINT



Legendary proportions: The Big Three amassed 66 Major titles, with Djokovic at 24 and the retired champions Nadal and Federer finishing with 22 and 20, respectively. GETTY IMAGES

Big Two dominance marks start of a new dawn

Two spectacular **young superstars** dominated men's tennis in 2024. Novak Djokovic salvaged a tough year with a prestigious title, while Rafael Nadal retired after an unforgettable career.

Paul Fein



FOR MORE
STORIES

For the first time since 2002, none of the iconic Big Three — Novak Djokovic, Rafael Nadal, and Roger Federer — captured a Grand Slam singles title. This triumvirate, by far the most accomplished players in men's tennis history, amassed 66 Major titles, with Djokovic at 24 and the retired champions Nadal and Federer finishing with 22 and 20, respectively. The age-defying

Serb proved he's not washed up at 37 by securing gold at the Paris Olympics. The new Big Two — Jannik Sinner and Carlos Alcaraz — confirmed Federer's maxim, much like Steffi Graf and Monica Seles did 35 years ago when they dethroned legendary queens Martina Navratilova and Chris Evert. Contrasting personalities and styles have already ignited the Alcaraz-Sinner rivalry. Fire vs Ice. Bold Creativity vs Relentless Power. Sinner finished the year ranked No. 1, but Alcaraz defeated him in all three encounters, most